

Skin Protection and Follow-up Plan

Personal health | Sun exposure is the job | Confidential

A working person's plan for skin on the water. After the spots removed from the forearms and nose, the dermatologist's message was simple: the damage is done, the job now is preventing more and catching anything early. This is the routine.

Daily on the water

- Broad-spectrum SPF 50, every morning, reapplied at midday on long days.
- Long-sleeve sun shirts and a wide brim; the shirt does more than the lotion over a full day.
- Backs of the hands and the ears - the spots people miss and where the sun lands hardest in a boat.
- Sunglasses; the glare off the water is its own exposure.

Checks

Item	Cadence	Notes
Dermatology skin check	twice a year	more if anything changes
Self-check	monthly	new, changing, or non-healing spots
Sunscreen restock	as needed	keep a tube in the truck and the boat

What to watch for

Anything that changes, will not heal, bleeds, or looks different from the spots around it. Actinic keratosis is the warning shot; the point of catching it is so it never becomes anything worse. Any new spot that worries me goes to the dermatologist, not to the internet and not to next season.

The honest part

The temptation on a busy harvest morning is to skip the routine. The routine is exactly what keeps the next removal from being a bigger deal. Two minutes of sunscreen against a lifetime on the water is not a hard trade.

Personal health note. Confidential. Follow-up with the treating dermatologist for anything that changes.